

prevailed not, and Sir Edward Coke being suspended from his office, Mr. Chamberlain told his friends on the fourteenth of the same month, "the Lord Coke is now quite off the hooks, and order given to send him a supersedeas from executing his place.

"The common speech is that four P's have overthrown and put him down; that is, Pride, Prohibitions, Premunire, and Prerogative."*

In retailing this popular gossip, Chamberlain had evidently no ill feeling towards the late Chief Justice; for, on the following 23rd of November, when addressing his correspondent, he thus remarks upon his displacement:

"If Sir Edward Coke could bear his misfortunes constantly, it were no disgrace to him, for he goes away with a general applause and good opinion. And the King himself, when he told his resolution at the council table to remove him, yet gave this character, that he thought him no ways corrupt, but a good justice—with so many other good words, as if he meant to hang him with a silken halter.

"Hitherto he bears himself well, but especially towards his lady, without any complaint of her

* Ibid, vol. iii, p. 226. Birch MSS. 4173.